

DESIGN REVIEW / POST #2163

Three classes. Nine distinct directions.

A mobile-first class identity proposal for Hunter, Shaman, and Priest. Each specialization receives a readable baseline loop before Talents 2.0 changes how it plays.

Hunter	Shaman	Priest
Command, position, or close into melee.	Bank storms, earn spells, or shape healing currents.	Link damage, deliver prayers, or spread sympathetic suffering.

THE LAYERING

#2163 restores the passive power floor. This proposal adds specialization identity, spec-owned actions, and class-wide talent choices as separate reviewable slices.

01 / SHARED FRAMEWORK

Identity first. Tuning second.

The goal is not to add more buttons. It is to make existing actions, resources, and visible states create a clear decision loop for every specialization.

Mobile responsiveness is a hard requirement

- Baseline rotations fit on a compact action bar.
- Most talents modify actions the player already owns.
- Core payoffs avoid precise ground placement and rapid retargeting.
- Color, animation, and combat logs are never the only actionable cues.
- Wrong-spec actions and states are removed on respec, reconnect, and loadout changes.

One owner, collaborative balance

One class owner covers all three specs and the class-wide rows. Cross-class tuning remains collaborative, with shared targets for damage, healing, survivability, and multiplicative scaling.

Talents 2.0 row jobs

05	Movement
08	Defense and survivability
11	Crowd control
14	Kit management or amplification
17	Major cooldown or power spike
20	Build-defining capstone

REVIEW BOUNDARY

What reviewers decide now

Approve the fantasy, baseline loop, shared versus exclusive ownership, mobile action count, and talent-row jobs. Final coefficients, proc rates, animation production, and encounter balance belong to implementation tests and PBE feedback.

02 / HUNTER

Three relationships with the hunt

Focus remains the shared resource. Each specialization changes where the Hunter stands, how the pet participates, and what the player is preparing for.

BEAST MASTERY DIRECTION / PET DAMAGE

Packlord

The beast is the weapon. Successful Pack Commands build Focus and the Hunter's visible Pack Ferocity buff. The pet mirrors those stacks by growing larger, redder, and stronger at cleaving.

Loop: Pack Command -> Fell Shot while the command recovers -> build three Ferocity stages -> Unleash Beast -> clap and frenzy -> calm.

Decision: spend Focus for pressure now, or hold the armed beast for the next target group or damage window.

MARKSMANSHIP DIRECTION / RANGED DAMAGE

Coldsight

Create room, build Focus deliberately, and commit to a powerful shot only when the position is safe. Movement is part of the decision rather than a passive penalty.

Loop: Measured Shot -> create space -> Long Draw for the primary hit -> Feathered Draw while movement prevents another long cast -> Cold Focus burst window.

Decision: continue building while mobile, or spend Focus before the safe firing window closes.

SURVIVAL DIRECTION / MELEE BLEED DAMAGE

Fieldcraft

A melee-led hunter built around entering the fight, opening wounds, exploiting them with traps and explosives, then leaving with a reason to return.

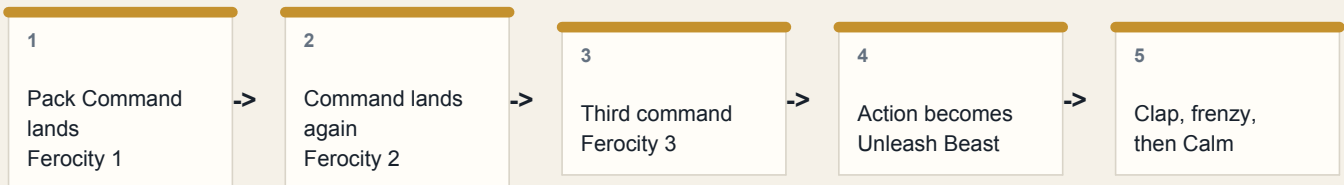
Loop: Bloodhook into melee and apply the bleed -> Gutting Strike -> Woundrend -> Shrapnel Charge -> Trailbreak out -> re-enter with preserved Hunting Momentum.

Decision: remain in melee for a stronger Momentum payoff, or disengage early to survive and preserve the next entry.

03 / HUNTER SPOTLIGHT

Ferocity is a Hunter state with a pet-sized consequence

The Hunter owns the authoritative three-stack buff. The active pet reads that state for its scale, tint, outline, effects, and cleave behavior.



Authoritative state

- The Hunter buff UI displays zero to three stacks.
- Only a successful commanded pet hit grants 20 Focus and one stage.
- No living pet, invalid target, or failed hit grants nothing.
- Pet attacks can maintain the window but cannot build it automatically.
- Pet death, dismissal, respec, or loadout change clears the state.

Derived pet presentation

- Stage 1: slight growth and a faint warm tint.
- Stage 2: clearer growth, redder tint, heavier attacks.
- Stage 3: largest safe scale, saturated red, persistent outline.
- Unleash: immediate primary hit, area clap, short cleaving frenzy.
- Calm: normal scale and color, Hunter buff returns to zero.

READABILITY AND SYNCHRONIZATION

Why the Hunter owns it

The mechanic remains visible when the pet is off-screen, obscured, or visually crowded. Offline and online simulation replicate one owner state, while pet graphics derive from it. Pack Command also transforms in place, so Unleash adds no extra rotation button.

Hunter utility direction

- Movement choices improve Trailbreak, the travel guise, or generator-driven mobility.
- Control choices amplify the existing interrupt, trap, slow, and root kit.
- Defensive choices improve Shellskin, pet recovery, or safe damage redirection.
- Capstones reinforce Focus, traps, or pet coordination instead of adding unrelated minigames.

04 / SHAMAN

One elemental backbone, three engines

Shared Jolts, wards, movement, and Mana remain recognizable. Each specialization adds one visible engine: a storm bank, a weapon cadence, or stored healing currents.

ELEMENTAL DIRECTION / RANGED DAMAGE

Thundercall

Arc Bolt gathers electrical pressure one successful impact at a time. The Shaman chooses when and where to vent a visible five-charge storm.

Loop: Arc Bolt builds Thunder -> bank up to five -> Earthen Jolt vents into one target or Faultwake vents into a group -> Primal Mastery accelerates the same loop.

Decision: discharge now for urgency, or keep banking for a larger and more efficient payoff.

ENHANCEMENT DIRECTION / MELEE DAMAGE OR OFF-TANK

Warspirit

Weapon hits earn spells. Galeheart is the offensive posture; Stonebound deliberately trades echoes and damage for armor, threat, smoothing, and emergency tank control.

Loop: choose weapon posture -> land three melee steps -> trigger Galeheart echoes and arm Stormcast -> spend the instant cast on damage, control, or Mending Waters.

Decision: choose pressure or protection, then decide how to spend each earned instant spell.

RESTORATION DIRECTION / PREPARED GROUP HEALING

Spiritmend

Healing behaves like a current. Mending Waters deposits a visible pool on an ally, Tidecall immediately heals and enlarges it, and Cascading Mend consumes every owned pool reached by its bounce.

Loop: establish Mending Currents -> enlarge the endangered or prepared target -> let pools tick efficiently or consume them through Cascading Mend for a large burst.

Decision: hold, enlarge, or consume the healing already prepared across the group.

05 / SHAMAN SPOTLIGHT

Posture, cadence, and prepared healing

Shaman depth comes from visible choices inside the existing elemental kit, not from a separate action bar for every element.

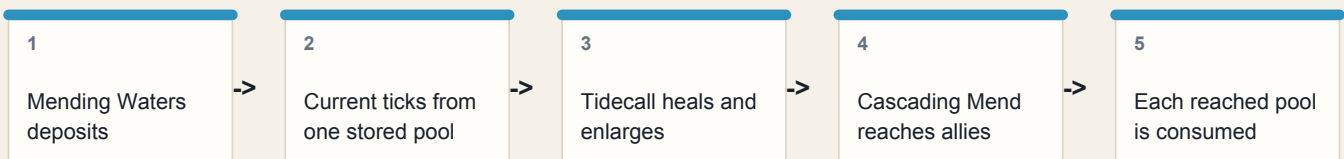
Galeheart Weapon

Every third landed melee step creates two non-recursive echoes and arms one cheaper instant spell. This is deterministic, visible, and tuned without random burst spikes.

Stonebound Weapon

Removes Galeheart echoes and grants the explicit off-tank package: armor, mitigation, threat, smoothing, snap threat, and short forced-target control.

Spiritmend consumption contract



Starting burst proposal

Each consumed Mending Current immediately heals for a proposed 125% of its remaining stored amount, in addition to the normal Cascading Mend heal. The pool is fully consumed even if some of the burst overheals.

The percentage, cap, duration, and Mana efficiency are PBE knobs. The fixed interaction is that every reached owned pool is consumed.

Role boundaries

- Warspirit can cover adds, emergencies, and suitable small-group encounters.
- It does not replace a dedicated tank for sustained boss mitigation.
- Spiritmend remains functional with only one injured ally.
- Thundercall's single-target and area vents remain explicit choices.
- All banks and postures receive compact aura and party-frame cues.

06 / PRIEST

Three forms of spiritual connection

Priest identity comes from choosing what is linked: one protected ally, a group awaiting a prayer, or enemies tied together through sympathetic suffering.

HYBRID HEALER / DAMAGE-LINKED PROTECTION

Discipline - Doctrine direction

Ward one chosen ally, then convert controlled offensive pressure into clean healing for that person. Direct healing remains available when no enemy can be safely attacked.

Loop: Psalm of Warding establishes the link -> Scouring Hymn or offensive Scouring Mercy produces linked healing -> Scouring Mercy can instead directly heal -> move the link as priorities change.

Decision: damage, ward, or heal directly, and decide who should receive the conversion.

IMMEDIATE GROUP HEALING / ANGELIC PROTECTION

Holy - Benison direction

Deliver the largest immediate prayers and place a visible Seraphic Vigil over one selected ally before danger arrives. Angels are attached protection states, not autonomous pets.

Loop: large single-target triage -> Seraphic Vigil on the endangered ally -> Choirmend when a large cast is safe -> Sunburst Canticle while moving -> Choir of Deliverance for sustained pressure.

Decision: commit to the cast, recover immediately, or protect one ally in advance.

RITUAL DAMAGE / SYMPATHETIC SUFFERING

Shadow - Vespers direction

Bind one prepared enemy as an Effigy, make its suffering echo through other hexed targets, bank Gloomtithe, then manifest that pain as an autonomous Tithefiend.

Loop: spread Dirge of Decay -> bind the Effigy with Mindfracture -> echo eligible damage -> build five Gloomtithe stages -> summon Tithefiend for pressure and Mana return.

Decision: spread for group echoes, concentrate on the Effigy, or summon early instead of banking.

07 / PRIEST SPOTLIGHT

Readable links, distinct healing, ritual shadow

The three specializations share spiritual language without sharing the same mechanic. Each link has a different owner, payoff, and presentation.

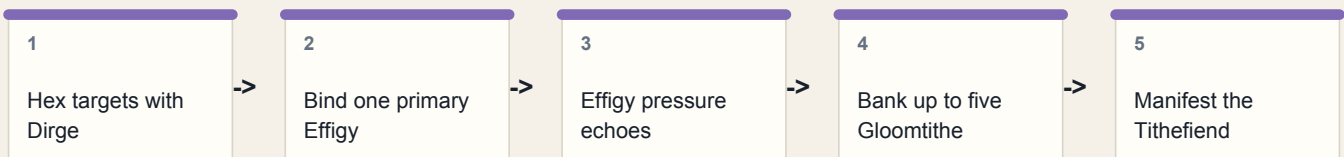
Doctrine: controlled conversion

One ally carries the primary link. Eligible damage heals that ally. Friendly Scouring Mercy and direct prayers remain clean fallback healing, and converted healing cannot recurse.

Benison: immediate commitment

No stored-healing pool. Choirmend is the large cast, Sunburst Canticle is the moving response, and Seraphic Vigil makes the protected ally unmistakable before danger.

Vespers ritual chain



Visual language

- Doctrine: ward mark, clear link, separate damage and healing events.
- Benison: attached halo or wings above the selected ally plus party-frame state.
- Vespers: Effigy dolls, masks, spectral smoke, woven hexes, and shadow creatures.
- Static outlines and aura stacks remain in reduced-motion and low-graphics modes.

Identity boundaries

- Doctrine is not passive full-party smart healing.
- Benison does not build or consume Spiritmend-style pools.
- Vespers avoids corpse armies, permanent demons, and generic damage-over-time identity.
- Only one primary link is required before a capstone explicitly changes it.

08 / DELIVERY

Small PRs, shared balance targets

The class direction can be reviewed together. Gameplay still lands as narrow slices with fail-first tests, PBE exposure, and explicit maintainer approval.

1	Design companion	PRDs, this PDF, and the responsive review prototype. No gameplay changes.
2	Shared spec infrastructure	Action replacement, wrong-spec cleanup, persistence, and hotbar rules behind existing seams.
3	Hunter slice	Packlord, Coldsight, and Fieldcraft mechanics with deterministic fail-first tests.
4	Shaman slice	Thundercall, Warspirit, and Spiritmend mechanics with deterministic fail-first tests.
5	Priest slice	Doctrine, Benison, and Vespers mechanics with deterministic fail-first tests.
6	PBE balance pass	Shared output, survivability, proc, pacing, and encounter targets across all nine specs.

BEFORE IMPLEMENTATION

Feedback requested

- Does each specialization have a distinct fantasy and repeatable loop?
- Are shared and spec-exclusive actions assigned correctly?
- Are the utility choices strong enough without creating excessive buttons?
- Can every required state be understood on a small screen?
- Which interactions need tuning rather than redesign before the first PBE slice?

Approval boundary: #2163 remains the passive power-floor restoration. Large gameplay redesign slices require approval from Levy or Fernando before implementation and then move through PBE before release.